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Performance:

The contest between the Samsung 173P and the Philips 170N was close, with just a one-point difference in scores between them. Lack of features such as height adjustment, and absence of colour calibration, made the Philips lose out on the overall score. However, if you just consider performance, the winner was the Samsung 172S.

In the point shape and visibility test, the Samsung 172S returned the best results, with the dot reproduced perfectly, without any pixel bleeding—this means it's a good choice for designers, graphic artists and movie editors.

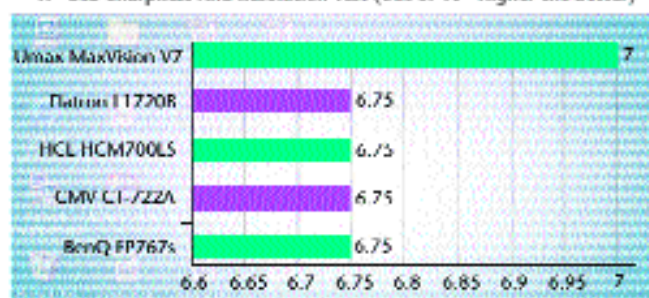
The Umax V7 was the best performer in the video bandwidth test—this means the V7 is a good choice for playing games at high

resolutions. Also, 3D software users can take advantage of its video bandwidth, as the monitor affords higher resolutions and refresh rates.

In the streaking and ghosting test, the Samsung 173P and the Philips 107N returned impressive results. We strained our eyes trying to find some slight streaking or ghosting, but there was none. These two are, therefore, good for movie buffs.

The Philips 170N returned excellent results in the level shift test, with no pixel bleeding at the edge. The Acer AL712 fared poorly here. People who use image-

17" LCD Sharpness And Resolution Test (Out of 10 - Higher the better)



restoring software, and also those who do image editing, should consider the Philips 170N.

All the monitors we tested gave average results in the text-colour combination test. We observed that text in magenta was consistently reproduced poorly, by all the panels. Magenta on dark colours, especially, appears crooked, and prominent black dots are visible between the magenta dots. The same was the case with red text on a dark background. We therefore advise marketing and sales people in advertising agencies to stay away from LCDs altogether for presentations, where dark backgrounds and coloured texts are used.

In the colour scales test, colours are presented from their darkest to their brightest areas. The NEC MultiSync 1760NX did the best. This was the only LCD where we could see the darkest as well as the brightest blocks. Other panels missed out on either the darker or on the brighter side.

The Samsung 173P stole the show in the performance department. It also scored high on looks, something which is very important for an expensive, lifestyle product such as an LCD panel.

Conclusion

Though LCD monitors are expensive, once you take a look at one of these beauties, you're sure to get hooked. There are 17-inch LCD monitors for all kinds of buyers—from those who want the best, to those who look at the price tag. Each monitor has its feature set and performance level, and is priced accordingly. Price drops will probably happen soon enough. We can also expect to see more vendors entering the market.

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Samsung SyncMaster 172MP	Samsung SyncMaster 172s	Umax Maxvision V7
0.264	0.264	0.264
250	270	250
700:1	350:1	400:1
56 - 75	56 - 75	56 - 75
31 - 81	30 - 81	31.5 - 80
1280 x 1024	1280 x 1024	1280 x 1024
135	135	NA
25	25	15
412 x 415 x 203	385 x 396.3 x 216	413 x 414 x 195
4.9	4.7	5.13
Y	N	Y
Y	Y	Y
N/Y	N/Y	N/Y
58 W	42 W	NA
Manual, natural colour driver, data cable, power cord, external TV tuner card, remote control	Manual, natural colour driver, data cable, power cord, power adapter, wall mount	Manual, power adapter, data cable, audio Cable
6.75	42.2	7
25		39.25
150		140 - 145
3.75	4	4
3.25	4	2.75
31	27	22
31.75	44.65	41.05
62.75	71.65	63.05
1.42	2.80	3.04
61,800	36,840	29,000
C	B+	B